

HEADLINE JUDGMENT

Score HOLDS at 27/30 for a ninth consecutive edition. No channel moved. And the composition has deteriorated further than at any point since 30 July. This edition follows a one-session gap and therefore publishes the 17 August close in full rather than as a reference. The single most important fact is that the interim US–Iran arrangement lapsed on 17 August with no extension and no successor process, and both parties have since confirmed it. The 17 June Memorandum of Understanding, brokered in Islamabad, carried a 60-day clock that expired on Monday; Bloomberg reported on 18 August that Trump ‘won’t try to revive’ it, and on the same day he said no talks are under way or scheduled — one day after telling Fox News that a direct back-channel to the IRGC existed, which Tehran and the IRGC both denied. UKMTO’s own Update 086 independently records the lapse, and attributes a rise in attack frequency to Iranian claims of a shift in posture now that the 60-day period has run. That shift was then stated on the record: Reuters reported on 17 August, from a senior Iranian official, that Iran is moving to a ‘fully offensive’ military posture, sets a deadline of ‘a few weeks’ for the US to implement the MoU, and is prepared to conduct a ‘timely and precise’ attack to break the naval blockade. On 18 August the UAE said two Iranian ballistic missiles were fired at its territory, the first such launch since May; both fell in or near territorial waters, Iran denied it, and residents received a phone alert two hours before the statement. And Washington threatened to bomb the mediator. Trump, on Fox News on 17 August: ‘if Oman gets in the way, we’ll bomb the s--- out of them’ — because, US officials told the Washington Post the next day, he is unhappy with Oman’s bilateral deal with Iran. The market read all of this the way the score cannot. Brent has risen on four consecutive sessions and the last confirmed close, \$89.45 on 18 August, is the highest since 31 July; the active contract closed \$91.02, its highest since 24 July. The oil channel — the only one of the six with headroom — is now \$5.55 from its upgrade on the scored series and \$3.98 on the active contract, from \$8.43 and \$6.48 a week ago. Second: this monitor got the 17 August close wrong in the most instructive way it has yet managed. The Singapore-morning snapshot carried Brent at \$86.43; it closed \$89.03. The gap of +\$2.60 is the largest upside crude reconciliation error the monitor has recorded, beating the +\$2.26 of 6 August. Worse, the snapshot carried the 30-year at 5.2593%, identical to the 14 August close to four decimal places, and — applying \$9.25, which holds that an identical value in a LIVE row is a market that has stopped moving — treated it as a genuine print. It was a stale carry. The 30-year closed 5.3060% on 17 August: a new war high, the first close above 5.30%, and 4.67 bp above the value published. The 2s10s spread closed 54.248 bp, the steepest since 19 May, not the 52.777 carried. \$9.25 is hereby corrected: an identical-to-four-decimals field is UNRESOLVED regardless of whether the row around it is live. That rule is applied to this edition’s own data, where the 5- and 10-year both print unchanged to four decimals against Tuesday and are reported as unresolved rather than flat. Third, the consequence: every de-risking reading of the last fortnight is now gone. 5Y5Y has closed above 2.30% on three consecutive sessions and at 2.3243% is 18.23 bp above the anchor that would release the US-inflation channel, widened from 16.74. BE10 closed 2.3077%, its highest since 15 June and 5.08 bp above its pre-war anchor — a fortnight ago it was 0.21 bp. MOVE closed 75.63 on 17 August, ending the three-session sub-75 run and returning above the pre-war anchor, before slipping to 74.98. Threshold B has been armed on three consecutive closes and on 17 August the 30-year leg cleared by 10.60 bp, the widest 30-year clearance of the war. The Treasury downgrade is further away than at any point in the conflict: the 30-year leg failed by 30.60 bp on Monday, the widest reading the war has produced. Physically, the strait is now measurably emptier than at any point. UKMTO Update 086 records ZERO cargo and ZERO tanker transits on both 15 and 16 August in its own annex, and takes the cumulative incident count 89 to 91 — of which the material one is 115-26, a general cargo ship struck by a projectile in the engine room 0.5 nautical miles off Oman, with ONE CREW FATALITY, assisted by the Omani Coast Guard. Oman has published nothing about it, as it has published nothing about the two tankers struck in its territorial waters on 14 August, and nothing about being threatened with bombardment. And the diplomatic track has been made conditional on a document that does not exist: Qatar said on 18 August that mediators will return to push for US–Iran talks after the Iran–Oman Hormuz deal is announced — a deal Tehran says is agreed, Muscat has never confirmed, and Baghaei conceded on 18 August is delayed by ‘destructive efforts’. Sequencing 27 → 27 → 27.

1 · Live tape

Oil and natural gas — Bloomberg front-month / active

19 Aug 2026 readings are intraday prints from the Singapore Wednesday morning. There was no 18 August edition, so this document covers two sessions and publishes the 17 August close in full (\$9.20). The last confirmed close, and the scoring reference throughout, is 18 August. d/d is 19 Aug intraday vs the 18 Aug close; w/w for every series runs against the 12 Aug close (five sheet-rows back), so the oil and rates bases do not diverge this edition. vs-pre-war is against the 27 Feb 2026 close, re-verified field by field and unchanged. The \$9.8 row check CLEARS decisively — the 17 Aug row settled with true closes that differ from the published snapshot on every field. Two fields are flagged under the corrected \$9.19: the 5-year (4.3656) and 10-year (4.7060) print identical to four decimals on 18 and 19 August. Basis note: the press quotes the ACTIVE contract; the scored CO2 continuation prints about \$1.57 below COA.

Benchmark	Intraday 19 Aug	Δ d/d	Δ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
Brent front-month	\$90.24 /bbl (H 90.40 / L 89.69)	+\$0.79 (+\$3.42 w/w vs 12 Aug)	from \$72.48 (+24.5%) — a \$17.76/bbl premium, the widest this document has carried since July. The overnight low of \$89.69 is above Tuesday’s close, so the Wednesday tone is firm and the range is a narrow 71 cents. Active COA prints \$91.81	CO2 Comdty (Close)
Brent · 18 Aug close (last confirmed — the scoring reference)	\$89.45 /bbl	+\$0.42 vs the 17 Aug close \$89.03	The highest Brent close since 31 July (\$90.12), and the THIRD consecutive up-close (14, 17 and 18 Aug); the 19 Aug intraday extends it to a fourth session if it holds. It leaves the channel \$5.55 below the \$95 upgrade trigger and \$16.97 above the \$72.48 downgrade anchor — against \$8.43 and \$14.09 in the last edition. The upgrade gap NARROWED by \$2.88, the largest single-edition narrowing of the war, and it has now narrowed in three consecutive editions. On the active contract the upgrade leg is only \$3.98 away, and COA’s \$91.02 close is its highest since 24 July. Still \$28.90 below the 31 Mar war high of \$118.35	CO2 Comdty (Close)

Benchmark	Intraday 19 Aug	Δ d/d	Δ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
Brent · 17 Aug close — PUBLISHED HERE IN FULL, AND THE LARGEST UPSIDE RECONCILIATION ERROR THE MONITOR HAS RECORDED	\$89.03 close vs \$86.43 carried	gap +\$2.60	The 17 August close was never published, and the snapshot on which the last edition was built understated it by \$2.60 — beating the +\$2.26 of 6 August as the largest upside crude gap on record. Running gap series: +\$1.97, −\$0.47, −\$3.99, +\$0.10, +\$2.26, +\$0.72, +\$0.87, −\$0.13, +\$1.29, +\$2.60 . The close was +\$2.46 on the day , not the −\$0.14 the last edition carried. The session drivers were the Kpler weekend transit collapse published that morning, Reuters' 'fully offensive' exclusive, the report that the blockade can run indefinitely, and Trump's Oman threat. The Singapore cut had seen none of them. \$9.1 and \$9.31: the snapshot misses the US session, and this is the sixth occasion on which a published reading has had to be withdrawn as a result	CO2 Comdty (Close)
WTI front-month	\$84.92 /bbl	+\$0.86 (+\$2.75 w/w)	from \$67.02 (+26.7%) — the 18 Aug close of \$84.06 is the highest since 24 July. CLA prints \$85.82 against CL2's \$84.92; the continuation artifact persists at about 90 cents	CL2 Comdty (Close)
Brent–WTI spread	\$5.32 /bbl front	\$5.39 on the 18 Aug close, from \$5.29 on 17 Aug	\$5.99 on the active contracts intraday, from \$6.08 on Tuesday and \$6.37 on Monday. The active spread peaked at \$6.37 on 17 Aug — wide, but NOT a war record: the war high is \$6.82 on 5 May . The last edition's 'widest active spread since 5 May' framing survives re-verification, but the spread has since narrowed on two consecutive sessions while crude rose , which is the opposite of the routing signature and is worth watching rather than asserting	derived
Henry Hub natural gas	\$2.783 /MMBtu	+\$0.007 (−\$0.021 w/w)	from \$3.06 (−9.1%) — the 17 Aug close of \$2.690 came within five cents of the \$2.640 war low of 6 August before Tuesday recovered nine cents. Henry Hub remains the cleanest evidence in the document that this is a Hormuz routing dislocation and not a global-energy shock: US gas is 9% BELOW its pre-war level on the same day European gas set a war record and Brent rose 24.5%	NGA Comdty (Close)
TTF Dutch gas (active)	€64.190 /MWh	+€0.544 (+€3.169 w/w)	from €31.23 (+105.6%) — it has now more than doubled. The 18 August close of €63.646 finished three-tenths of a cent BELOW the €63.649 war record of 24 July: the record survives on closes, by a margin too small to be meaningful. The 19 Aug intraday print of €64.190 is above it, but an intraday print does not set a record and is not treated as one. Cited drivers are unchanged: Qatari cargo delays forcing European buyers to bid against Asia, and storage well below the five-year average	TZTA Comdty (Close)
Japan/Asia LNG (18 Aug close — no 19 Aug print)	¥3,447	+¥13 vs the 17 Aug close ¥3,434	from ¥1,669 (+106.5%) — the highest print since 30 July (¥3,527) , and it has now risen on three consecutive prints (3,363 / 3,434 / 3,447). No 19 Aug print, flagged and NOT carried as a reading. The 11 Aug hole was never backfilled and is permanent. Hormuz still moves roughly a fifth of global LNG, and Bloomberg reported on 17 August that LNG carriers have now begun ship-to-ship transfers — the covert relay extending from crude into gas	JGLA Comdty (Close)

US Treasuries and inflation expectations — Bloomberg

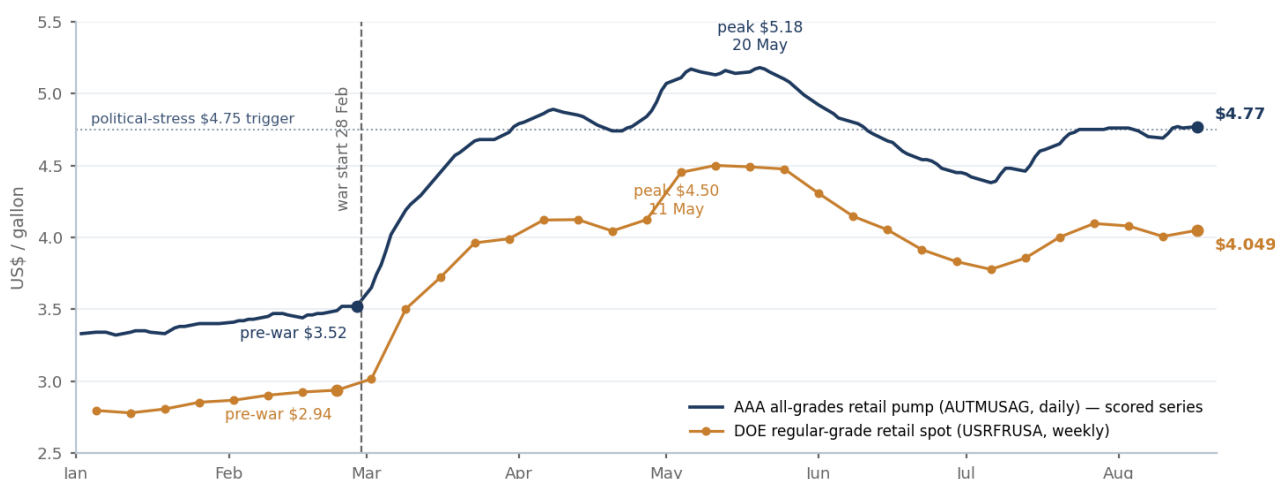
The curve printed on all three sessions. Triggers and Stage-4 tests below are judged on the 18 Aug close. The corrected \$9.19 is applied twice in this table. The last edition observed the 30-year printing 5.2593% on both 14 and 17 August and, because the row was live, treated it as genuine under \$9.25. It was a carry: the 17 August close was 5.3060%, a new war high. The rule is therefore restated — an identical-to-4dp field is UNRESOLVED regardless of row liveness — and applied here to the 5-year and the 10-year, which print unchanged to four decimals on 18 and 19 August and are reported as unresolved rather than as a flat market.

Tenor	Intraday 19 Aug (%)	Δ d/d (bp)	18 Aug close	Δ vs pre-war (bp) and commentary	BBG ticker
2-year UST	4.1729	+0.20	4.1709	+79.8 (from 3.37%) — the front end has barely moved across the two sessions: +0.62 bp on Monday, −0.44 on Tuesday. That is the whole point of the week. The tenor that trades the Fed is flat while the long end set a war high and gave part of it back. Note the market prices a September HIKE , not a cut, at roughly 31% on the freshest CME FedWatch reading available (14 Aug)	USGG2YR Index
5-year UST	4.3656 (unchanged to 4dp — UNRESOLVED, corrected \$9.19)	n/a	4.3656	+86.4 (from 3.50%) — the 17 Aug close rose 1.06 bp to 4.3745 and Tuesday gave back 0.89. The 19 Aug value is identical to Tuesday to four decimal places and is not treated as a reading; under the corrected rule no d/d is asserted	USGG5YR Index
10-year UST	4.7060 (unchanged to 4dp — UNRESOLVED, corrected \$9.19)	n/a	4.7060	+76.9 (from 3.94%) — the 17 Aug close of 4.7219% was the highest since the 31 July war high of 4.7347% , up 2.97 bp, before Tuesday gave back 1.59. It is the tenor holding Threshold B armed. As with the 5-year, the 19 Aug print is identical to four decimals and is reported unresolved	USGG10YR Index
30-year UST	5.2879	+0.21	5.2858	+67.7 (from 4.61%) — THE HEADLINE MARKET FACT OF THIS EDITION. The 17 August close of 5.3060% is a NEW WAR HIGH and the first close above 5.30% , taking out the 5.2724% of 31 July, and it is 4.67 bp above the value the last edition published as a genuine print. It is 9.00 bp above the 5.216% at which the 13 August auction cleared and 25.60 bp above the 13 May stop of 5.050%. Tuesday retraced 2.02 bp. The Treasury downgrade leg needs a close under 5.00%: it failed by 30.60 bp on Monday, the WIDEST gap of the war, and by 28.58 bp on Tuesday, from 25.93	USGG30YR Index
2s10s spread	+53.109 bp	−0.195	+53.304	−2.5 vs +55.64 pre-war — the 17 August close of 54.248 bp is the steepest since 19 May, not the 52.777 the last edition carried , and it was a bear steepener: 2Y +0.62 bp against 10Y +2.97. Two sessions of mild flattening have followed. The curve is re-steepening from the long end on term premium rather than from the front end on cuts, which is the more expensive version and the one consistent with a war high in the 30-year	USYC2Y10 Index
10-year breakeven	2.3068	−0.09	2.3077	+50.8 vs 2.2569 pre-war — the 18 August close is the highest BE10 since 15 June. A fortnight ago this monitor reported spot inflation compensation as 0.21 bp from going below its pre-war level for the first time in the war. It is now 5.08 bp ABOVE it and has risen on two of the last three closes. The de-risking of early August has been fully unwound in the series that measures it most directly	USGGBE10 Index
5y5y forward breakeven	2.3179	−0.64	2.3243	+18.23 on the 18 Aug close, which is the figure the trigger uses, vs 2.142% pre-war — a THIRD consecutive close above the 2.30% level whose sustained break fired this channel 4→5 on 31 July (2.3082, 2.3243, and 2.3179 intraday). The 13 August close of 2.2900% now stands as an isolated single session. The documented downgrade remains a sustained close at or below the 2.142% anchor: 18.23 bp away, WIDENED from 16.74 and from 14.80 the edition before. \$9.26(b) is honoured — the rule was not moved when the trigger broke and it is not moved now	USGG5Y5Y Index

Cross-asset stress and political-transmission gauges — Bloomberg

Gauge	Latest	Basis	Δ vs pre-war	Reading
MOVE (rate vol)	74.98	18 Aug close (no 19 Aug print)	+1.60 (from 73.38)	THE SUB-75 RUN ENDED AT THREE SESSIONS, AND MOVE IS BACK ABOVE ITS PRE-WAR ANCHOR. The series went 72.09, 69.23, 69.58 — then 75.63 on 17 August, a 6.05-point jump — then 74.98. The 14 August framing of MOVE as sitting below its pre-war anchor is withdrawn : it has closed above 73.38 on both sessions since. Tuesday's 74.98 is technically back below 75 by two hundredths, which under \$9.18 is a session and not a regime. None of this can move the channel, and the reason has widened: the 30-year leg failed by 30.60 bp on Monday, the widest gap of the war, and 28.58 bp on Tuesday. \$9.15 rotation is now at its most extreme reading — the two legs have never been further from being simultaneously satisfied.
VIX (equity vol)	15.84	18 Aug close (no 19 Aug print)	−4.02 (from 19.86)	Up 1.59 points from the 14.25 series low of 14 August, in two sessions. The 14.25 print remains the lowest anywhere in the series, pre-war included , but equity volatility has begun to re-price: 14.25, 15.19, 15.84. The move coincides with the MoU lapse, the Iranian 'fully offensive' statement and the missiles fired at the UAE. It is a small move off a very low base and is reported as direction, not as stress.
DXY (dollar)	99.649	19 Aug intraday	+2.04 (from 97.608)	Flat across all three sessions — 99.637, 99.657, 99.649 — a range of two hundredths. A dollar that will not move while the 30-year sets a war high is the term-premium signature rather than the safe-haven one: a genuine geopolitical flight would bid the dollar and the long bond together, and here the long bond is being sold.
SOFR	3.66	17 Aug close (18 and 19 Aug blank)	−0.02 (from 3.68)	A new print on 17 August at 3.66, up from 3.62 , then two dark sessions. The four-basis-point rise is the largest single-session move in the series since July and coincides with the \$125bn August refunding settling on 17 August — a settlement effect, not funding stress. The series is not reporting for 18 or 19 August and is not treated as if it were.
AAA gasoline	\$4.77 /gal	17 Aug print (18 and 19 Aug blank)	+\$1.25 (from \$3.52, +35.5%)	Political-stress score reference. \$4.77 on 17 August, level with 13 August and the joint-highest reading since 10 June. The \$4.60 downgrade condition named on 11 August is 17 cents away, unchanged from the last edition and against 9 cents two editions ago. Two dark sessions since. Basis note: all-grades. AAA's own daily regular series printed \$4.0654 on 18 August , up from \$4.0116 a week earlier.
DOE gasoline	\$4.049 /gal	week of 17 Aug (released Tue 18 Aug)	+\$1.11 (from ~\$2.94, +37.7%)	Corroboration only. THE INDEPENDENT WEEKLY CORROBORATION ARRIVED AND IT CONFIRMS THE REVERSAL: \$4.049, up 4.3 cents from \$4.006 , reversing the prior week's decline. The release day has indeed moved to Tuesdays. The rise is entirely interior — Rocky Mountain +16.4c, Midwest +12.2c, Gulf Coast +7.9c — while the East Coast fell 2.1c and California fell 3.1c. Diesel is the real move: the DOE national on-highway average rose 19.7 cents to \$5.454, and AAA diesel reached \$5.4677 on 18 August, within 35 cents of its all-time record of \$5.8159.

US retail gasoline — the two tracked series, 2026 year-to-date



AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades retail pump, daily) is the political-stress score reference (pre-war \$3.52, peak \$5.18, latest print **\$4.77 on 17 Aug**; 18 and 19 Aug blank); USRFRUSA (DOE regular-grade retail spot, weekly) is corroboration only (pre-war ~\$2.94, peak \$4.50, latest **\$4.049 for the week of 17 Aug**). The dotted line is the \$4.75 political→5 threshold. **Both series now point the same way, which is the change this edition records.** The navy line sits above the trigger and has held there for five prints; the amber line, which had captured only the early-August decline, turned up 4.3 cents on its first reading since. What the chart cannot show is where the pressure actually is: **the US front-month diesel crack hit an all-time high of \$102.20/bbl on 17 August**, roughly five times normal, with European diesel near \$170/bbl against Brent at \$91 — and US distillate stocks 12% below the five-year average, near 23-year lows.

Strait operational state

Indicator	Current reading	Source
Strait closed · day 173 — UKMTO 086 RECORDS ZERO TRANSITS ON TWO CONSECUTIVE DAYS AND A CREW FATALITY 0.5NM OFF OMAN. COUNT 89 to 91	UKMTO JMIC Advisory Update 086, covering 1 Mar to 18 Aug (ICOD 181500Z), has been retrieved and read directly. All threat levels held — Hormuz SEVERE , Gulf of Oman, Bab el-Mandeb and Gulf of Aden SUBSTANTIAL , Arabian Gulf and Arabian Sea MODERATE , East Med LOW , regional JMIC#001-26 SEVERE . Cumulative incidents 89 to 91. UKMTO 115-26 is the material one: a general cargo ship transiting SOUTHBOUND, 0.5 nautical miles off the coast of Oman , struck by an unknown projectile in the engine room, with ONE CREW FATALITY ; SSAS alerts at 1848 UTC, AIS resumed 0130 UTC, the Omani Coast Guard rendered assistance . The advisory heads it 18 Aug but its own timeline implies the strike fell on the evening of 17 Aug UTC; both are reported and neither is asserted. A casualty conflict is recorded and not reconciled: UKMTO says one fatality, The National says one injured. UKMTO 114-26 is a Somali-basin hijack of the MV LUTUF and is NOT Iran-related ; it is counted in the cumulative total but carries no Hormuz read. The annex is the emptiest of the war: Hormuz cargo 5 / 0 / 0 / 0 and tankers 0 / 0 / 0 / 3 across 14–17 Aug — two consecutive days of zero transits of any kind — against a stated ~138/day 2025 baseline, with 42 US NCAGS-facilitated transits over the 16–17 Aug 48 hours (a facilitated subset, a different universe, never added to the annex). Update 086 also notes AIS-on vessels are receiving directed hails instructing them to divert to the northern Iranian-controlled route , and that mine danger areas remain active. Update 087 is not published; VRA Overview No.3 is not published.	UKMTO JMIC Update 086 (to 18 Aug), read directly at ukmto.org
UKMTO 086 ATTRIBUTES THE ATTACK RISE TO THE MoU LAPSE — THE PRIMARY MILITARY SOURCE CONFIRMS THE DEADLINE WAS REAL	This resolves the open question the last edition flagged as the most consequential dated item in the document. Update 086 assesses that the increase in attack frequency 'may coincide with Iranian claims of a shift in posture now that the 60-day period following the 17 June U.S.-Iran MOU has lapsed' . Tier 1 corroboration is comprehensive: Al Jazeera (17 Aug) — the MoU 'expired on Monday amid faltering talks'; CNN, CBS, CNBC and the New York Times (17 Aug) ; and decisively Bloomberg (18 Aug): 'Trump Refuses Iran Truce Extension' , reporting he will not try to revive it. The circulating '12 August agreement to extend' is RETRACTED: it traces to a single Tier 2 report citing unnamed Pakistani sources, was never corroborated, and has been falsified by events. Baghaei's counter-framing is recorded: because of alleged US violation 'the issue of a 60-day deadline became entirely moot'. Both sides now deny the deadline mattered, which is itself the evidence that no successor process exists.	UKMTO Update 086 / Al Jazeera, CNN, CBS, CNBC, NYT, 17 Aug / Bloomberg, 18 Aug
IRAN STATES A 'FULLY OFFENSIVE' POSTURE AND A FEW-WEEKS ULTIMATUM — AN ANNOUNCEMENT, NOT AN EVENT	Reuters, 17 Aug, citing a senior Iranian official: Iran will shift to a 'fully offensive' military posture because talks have stalled; Iranian entities 'must be prepared to escalate tensions in the Strait of Hormuz and wider region' ; Iran would conduct a 'timely and precise' military attack to break the US naval blockade if diplomacy failed; and it sets a deadline of 'a few weeks' for full US implementation of the MoU as a precondition for further talks. Per \$9.11 this is an ANNOUNCEMENT and the escalation channel does not move on it — the channel is at max in any case. Ghalibaf, Speaker of the Majlis, on 18 Aug: the strait remains closed until the US lifts the blockade, unfreezes assets, eases sanctions and halts military operations on all fronts. Note the title correction: Ghalibaf is Speaker, not — as one outlet had it — Tehran's top negotiator. Against the announcement: CENTCOM's public release index still shows nothing on combat inside Iran since 29 July, now a 21-day gap, verified directly. A circulating claim that the US struck Iran overnight around 18 Aug could not be sourced to any Tier 1 outlet and is contradicted by that index; it is REJECTED.	Reuters exclusive, 17 Aug / Ghalibaf via Washington Times and The National, 18 Aug / centcom.mil release index, read 19 Aug
IRAN FIRED TWO BALLISTIC MISSILES AT THE UAE ON 18 AUGUST — THE FIRST SUCH LAUNCH SINCE MAY	The UAE said its air defences detected two ballistic missiles launched from Iran toward the country , the first falling outside its territorial waters and the second within them. The statement followed a phone alert to UAE residents warning of a potential missile threat by about two hours. No impacts on land and no casualties. Iran denied targeting the UAE. Tier 1: Bloomberg, AP, Al Jazeera and Euronews, all 18 Aug. This is an EVENT, not an announcement, and it is a state-on-state ballistic launch at a Gulf partner — the first since May 2026. It is not captured in UKMTO 086, which closed at 1500Z and covers maritime security rather than air defence. Context: the UAE named Iran and used the word 'piracy' on 14 Aug over two ADNOC-affiliated vessels, and the GCC Secretary-General condemned it on 14 Aug. NOT FOUND, and it matters: any UAE or GCC sanction, designation, emergency session or UNSC referral flowing from that language. The rhetoric has not become an instrument.	UAE government via Bloomberg, AP, Al Jazeera and Euronews, 18 Aug / GCC Secretariat, 14 Aug
TRUMP THREATENED TO BOMB THE MEDIATOR, AND THE STATED REASON IS OMAN'S DEAL WITH IRAN	Trump, Fox News, 17 Aug: 'If Oman gets in the way, we'll bomb the s--- out of them.' Corroborated Tier 1 by CNN, CBS, the Washington Post and Al Jazeera. The Washington Post reported on 18 Aug, citing US officials, that the trigger is Oman's bilateral Hormuz arrangement with Iran. It is his second such threat — the first was at a cabinet meeting on 27 May. In the same interview he said Iran should surrender and claimed a direct back-channel with the IRGC; Baghaei called that report psychological warfare and the IRGC denied it outright (via Tasnim, Tier 3, relayed by Al Jazeera). On 18 August Trump said no talks are taking place or scheduled — the day after asserting the channel existed. Kushner, Fox News, 18 Aug: contacts are 'probably more robust than it's maybe ever been... we're not there yet ', and Trump does not want to rush a deal. NOT FOUND: any Hegseth or SecDef statement on Iran or Hormuz, 17–19 Aug.	Trump via Fox News, 17 Aug, corroborated by CNN/CBS/WaPo/Al Jazeera / WaPo, 18 Aug / CNN live blog, 18 Aug / The National, 18 Aug

Indicator	Current reading	Source
THE BLOCKADE TALLY ROSE 62 to 64 — AND THE PACE HAS COLLAPSED BECAUSE THERE IS ALMOST NOTHING LEFT TO REDIRECT	CENTCOM stated on 17 August, on its own official account and independently reproduced in UKMTO Update 086: 64 commercial vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded. The series runs 44 (3 Aug), 55 (9 Aug), 59 (13 Aug), 62 (14 Aug), 64 (17 Aug). Two more in three days, against eleven in the preceding six — the deceleration is consistent with an annex showing zero transits on two of those days. A discrepancy is flagged and NOT used: a caption on CENTCOM's own media page cites 91 redirected. It is irreconcilable with 64 and is not carried. On the carriers: USS George Washington had NOT entered the CENTCOM area of responsibility as of 17 August — it transited the Malacca Strait on 13 Aug and was last placed at an undisclosed Indian Ocean location — so both USS Abraham Lincoln and USS George H.W. Bush remain on station. The acting Navy Secretary calls the relief a ' planned rotation '; the Washington Post and CNN tie it to reported material and habitability problems aboard the Lincoln. NO OFAC Iran action 17–19 Aug — the only entry in the window is an 18 Aug ICC and Venezuela package. Bessent's trailed measures have not landed.	CENTCOM official post, 17 Aug, and UKMTO Update 086 / TWZ carrier tracker, 17 Aug / navy.mil, 14 Aug / ofac.treasury.gov recent actions, read 19 Aug
THE IRAN–OMAN ROUTE MAP IS AGREED ACCORDING TO TEHRAN, UNCONFIRMED BY MUSCAT, AND NOW THE GATE ON ALL MEDIATION	Baghaei, 17 Aug: Iran and Oman have agreed the MAP of the new route and are preparing a joint declaration , the deal to be finalised as a package of map plus statement. Reported structure: vessels enter near the Iranian coast and exit along the Omani side, with no transit fees or tolls during a transitional period of two to four months , convertible to a final route. Baghaei, 18 Aug: the joint announcement is NOT finalised , delayed by the complexity of the talks and by unnamed ' destructive efforts '. Araghchi's decoupling has hardened — the negotiations and reopening are 'two separate issues'. And Qatar has made this document the precondition for everything else: its foreign ministry said on 18 August that mediators will return to push for US–Iran talks AFTER the Hormuz deal is announced. The entire diplomatic track is therefore gated on an instrument that is single-sourced to Tehran, unconfirmed by the counterparty, and whose co-signatory has just been threatened with bombardment by the blockading power. NOT FOUND: any Omani confirmation, any published fee or security terms, any joint working-group readout 17–19 Aug.	Baghaei via WaPo and Reuters, 17 Aug, and Al Jazeera and The National, 18 Aug / Qatar MFA via Al Jazeera, 18 Aug
Oman — the precise query, and the precise answer	Per \$9.23 this row states exactly what was asked of the primary source. Both fm.gov.om indexes — news and statements — were read directly on 19 Aug. (a) The most recent item of ANY kind is 17 Aug: Sultan Haitham bin Tarik made a 'special fraternal visit' to the UAE , meeting Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed, with a delegation including the Deputy PM for Defence Affairs, the Interior Minister and the Transport Minister . The readout says only that regional developments and ways to advance security and stability were discussed. The composition is a security-and-shipping delegation; the readout does not say so, and no inference is scored on it. (b) The most recent Iran/Hormuz-relevant news item remains 8 Aug ; the most recent Hormuz-specific statement remains 14 July ; the most recent Oman–Iran joint statement remains 23 June . (c) Nothing whatever was published on 18 or 19 August. The material negatives, all verified against the ministry's own indexes rather than inferred: Oman has published nothing on the two tankers struck in its territorial waters on 14 August; nothing on UKMTO 115-26, in which a seafarer died 0.5nm off its coast and its own Coast Guard responded; and nothing in reply to being threatened with bombardment by the President of the United States. Al Jazeera separately notes Muscat has not publicly stated it intends to join Iran in controlling the strait.	Oman Ministry of Foreign Affairs, fm.gov.om news and statements indexes, read directly 19 Aug / Al Jazeera, 18 Aug
FOUR TRANSIT COUNTS, FOUR UNIVERSES, NO AVERAGE TAKEN	UKMTO annex (S&P/SeaVision, non-facilitated): 0 cargo and 0 tankers on both 15 and 16 Aug; 0 and 3 on 17 Aug , against its ~138/day 2025 baseline. Kpler via Reuters: 5 on 15 Aug, ZERO on 16 Aug — a weekend total of 5 against 31 the weekend before , on a stated pre-war baseline of 'more than 130 ships a day'; no Kpler figure for 17–19 Aug. Windward, the broadest universe because it adds satellite detection of dark transits: 12 total on 16 Aug, 8 inbound and 4 outbound, with the dark share above 50% in both directions and vessels running dark for 8–17 hours; Windward publishes no percentage-of-normal and warns its own series is sensitive to collection effort. TankerMap, AIS tankers only: 2 / 1 / 1 / 0 across 15–18 Aug, a 7-day average of 1.1 against its own stated ~21/day, with zero LNG transits every day since 30 July. IMF PortWatch: 1 transit on 16 Aug against its own 73/day baseline. Lloyd's List (cargo over 10,000 dwt, weekly): 78 for 3–9 Aug, from 95 — the 10–16 Aug brief was not retrievable. LSEG publishes no transit count at all. No provider published a 19 August figure. The four universes point the same way and the residual gap between Windward's 12 and UKMTO's 0 is transponder-off traffic, which is the finding rather than a discrepancy.	UKMTO Update 086 annex / Kpler via Reuters, 18 Aug / Windward MIOC, 17 Aug (16 Aug data) / TankerMap, read 19 Aug / IMF PortWatch via Straits, 18 Aug / Lloyd's List, 12 Aug
THE COVERT RELAY EXTENDED INTO LNG, ARAMCO RESUMED LOADING INSIDE THE STRAIT, AND THE BLOCKADE WAS BREACHED ONCE	Bloomberg, 17 Aug: LNG tankers now appear to be conducting ship-to-ship transfers — the relay measured last week in crude has extended to gas. Reuters, 18 Aug, on Kpler and Vortexa data: Saudi Aramco resumed crude loadings at Ras Tanura and Juaymah, ending a three-week gap , with three VLCCs each lifting about 2 mn bbl between 12 and 16 Aug and six more potentially loading later this month; LSEG places seven Bahri VLCCs off the UAE and Oman on 18 Aug with two more heading for Fujairah. Aramco's Red Sea workaround is impaired: about 670,000 b/d is expected to load at Sidi Kerir this month against roughly 4 mb/d previously exported via Yanbu, where 20 vessels have now sat fully AIS-dark for a sixth consecutive week. Windward assesses the first breach of the blockade since it was reimposed on 13 July : the US-sanctioned LPG carrier AXON I , broadcasting a false Angola flag, took an STS transfer from the sanctioned SALUTE off Oman on 10–11 Aug after seven dark days, then switched declared destination twice. Kharg: all three terminals were empty on both 16 August satellite passes , with an assessed 15 dark tankers holding ~16.7 mn bbl in floating storage and the longest-waiting vessel present since mid-May. GPS jamming in the Gulf hit 615 vessels on 16 Aug, +261% on its seven-day average , with 4,472 false STS meetings in a single day.	Bloomberg, 17 Aug / Reuters via Kpler and Vortexa, 18 Aug / LSEG via Reuters, 18 Aug / Windward MIOC, 17 Aug

Indicator	Current reading	Source
THE RED SEA LEG IS UNCHANGED AND STILL BAD — AL-MOKHA REMAINS COMPLETELY CLOSED	Update 086 records no confirmed attacks in the southern Red Sea or Bab el-Mandeb in the reporting period , and confirms Al-Mokha port remains completely closed to commercial traffic after more than 25 cumulative missile impacts and berth fires, forcing lower Red Sea logistics to reroute. Bab el-Mandeb transits: 59 over the 16–17 Aug 48 hours against a ~61/day 2023 baseline — roughly half normal. UKMTO assesses Houthi enforcement as selective , targeting Saudi- or Yemeni-government-linked assets, with broad indiscriminate attacks ‘possible but not probable’. The Houthis claimed a drone attack on Aramco’s Jazan refinery on 18 August via SABA (Tier 3), and NO Tier 1 outlet corroborated it and neither Saudi Arabia nor Aramco commented — it is carried as a CLAIM only , unlike the 9 and 13 August strikes which were confirmed. It would be the third in ten days. The 400,000 b/d Jizan restart remains scheduled for 30 August and no revision was found ; whether the claimed 18 Aug strike affects it cannot be established. Five vessels remain under pirate or unauthorised control (HONOUR 25, SWARD, EUREKA, ASANA, and now LUTUF).	UKMTO Update 086 / SABA (Tier 3) via Middle East Monitor, 18 Aug / Reuters citing IIR, 10 Aug

2 · US economic shock — analysis with bond yields

2.1 · Bond-yield transmission, channel by channel

(i) What the market did. (ii) What it means for the channel. (iii) What would change the score. All tests run on the **18 August close**, the last confirmed one, with the 17 August close published in full because no edition carried it. **Monday is the analytically important session**: it combined a new war high in the 30-year, the steepest 2s10s since 19 May and a six-point jump in rate volatility with the lapse of the US-Iran MoU and a \$2.46 rise in Brent.

Channel 3 · US inflation impulse — held at 5/5

(i) 5Y5Y closed **2.3082%** on 17 August and **2.3243%** on 18 August, up 1.61 bp — a **third consecutive close above the 2.30% level** whose sustained break fired this channel to 5 on 31 July. BE10 closed **2.2852%** then **2.3077%**, up 2.25 bp, **its highest since 15 June**. Import prices fell 0.4% m/m and export prices 1.3%, the latter a five-sigma miss, with import fuel down 7.2%. (ii) The pattern is the one that matters for this channel: **imported goods disinflation is running alongside rising domestic inflation compensation**. The 13 August break below 2.30% now stands as an isolated single session, and the corroborating series has moved further and faster — BE10 has travelled from 0.21 bp above its pre-war anchor on 13 August to **5.08 bp above** in three closes. A market that marks up ten-year spot compensation while tradeable goods prices fall is pricing something that does not arrive through the exchange rate. It is pricing energy, and specifically the distillate barrel, where the front-month crack set an all-time high of \$102.20 on 17 August. (iii) The documented downgrade is a **sustained close at or below the 2.142% pre-war anchor: 18.23 bp away and widened for a second consecutive edition**, from 16.74 and before that 14.80. Nothing in this window moves the channel, and the tension \$9.16 identified has resolved in the direction that vindicates hysteresis rather than the one that embarrasses it.

Channel 4 · Treasury stress — held at 5/5

(i) **The 30-year closed 5.3060% on 17 August: a new war high and the first close above 5.30%**, taking out the 5.2724% of 31 July, on a 4.67 bp rise. The 10-year closed 4.7219%, its highest since the 31 July war high, and 2s10s closed **54.248 bp, the steepest since 19 May. MOVE closed 75.63, a 6.05-point jump that ended the three-session sub-75 run and put rate volatility back above its 73.38 pre-war anchor**. Tuesday retraced modestly — 30Y 5.2858%, MOVE 74.98. (ii) Three things follow. **First, the last edition's reading of this channel was built on a stale field**. It published the 30-year at 5.2593%, unchanged to four decimals, and reasoned that because the row was live the print was genuine. The close was 47 hundredths of a percentage point higher and set a record. **Second, the rotation described in \$9.15 has reached its widest reading of the war**. The volatility leg and the yield leg have never been further from simultaneous satisfaction: MOVE went from 4.15 points below the pre-war anchor to 2.25 above it, while the 30-year leg went from failing by 25.93 bp to failing by **30.60 bp on Monday, the widest gap the war has produced**, and 28.58 on Tuesday. **Both legs moved away at 'once**, which has not happened before. **Third, the composition of the move matters**. The 2-year rose 0.62 bp on Monday against the 30-year's 4.67. This is not a repricing of the policy rate; it is a repricing of the term premium, on a day whose news was the collapse of a diplomatic process and a threat to attack a naval blockade. (iii) The downgrade needs a 30-year close beneath 5.00% **together with MOVE beneath 75**, sustained. Neither leg is satisfied and the binding one is further away than at any point in the conflict. **The 20-year auction on 19 August and the 30-year TIPS reopening on 20 August fall after this snapshot** and are the next tests; per \$9.29 the reading to take is the bid composition, not the tail.

Channel 2 · Oil price shock — held at 2/5, and it is the only channel that can move

(i) Brent has closed higher on three consecutive sessions — \$86.57, \$89.03, \$89.45 — with the 19 August intraday at \$90.24 extending it to a fourth if it holds. **The 18 August close of \$89.45 is the highest since 31 July**; the active contract at \$91.02 is the highest since 24 July. TTF closed within three-tenths of a cent of its war record and Asia LNG reached its highest since 30 July. Henry Hub, alone, remains **9.1% below its pre-war level**. (ii) The market commentary is consistent and it is not about supply loss: Bloomberg, counting on its own series, attributed a fourth consecutive daily gain to **stalemate rather than escalation** — no progress toward resolution after almost six months. The specific catalysts were the Kpler weekend transit collapse published Monday, the projectile strike on a vessel off Oman, the statement that the blockade can run indefinitely, and the record diesel crack pulling crude up from the product end. **What is NOT in the price is a physical outage**, and the reason is the covert relay: Bloomberg's satellite work and Reuters' report of Aramco resuming loadings inside the strait describe a system moving barrels around a closed waterway at scale. Energy Secretary Wright put Hormuz throughput at **9 mb/d over the prior seven days, roughly half pre-war rates**. (iii) The upgrade needs **sustained closes above \$95**. On the scored CO2 continuation the gap is **\$5.55, from \$8.43 and before that \$9.78 — narrowed in three consecutive editions and by \$2.88 in this one, the largest single-edition narrowing of the war**. On the active contract, which is what the press and most counterparties quote, the gap is **\$3.98**. The downgrade to 1 needs a mediated pause AND a close at or below \$72.48; the price leg alone is \$16.97 away and widening. **This is the only headroom in the instrument, and it is closing**.

Channel 5 · Political stress — held at 5/5

(i) AUTMUSAG printed **\$4.77 on 17 August**, level with 13 August and the joint-highest since 10 June, then went dark for two sessions. **The corroborating DOE weekly arrived on Tuesday 18 August at \$4.049, up 4.3 cents**, reversing the prior week's fall. (ii) **The independent confirmation the last edition was waiting for has arrived and it confirms the reversal**. Both series now point the same way, which removes the ambiguity that made the 12 August downgrade candidate look live. The composition is politically pointed: the national rise is **entirely interior** — Rocky Mountain +16.4 cents, Midwest +12.2, Ohio +28.1, Denver +23.3 — while **the East Coast fell 2.1 cents and California fell 3.1**. And the pressure has rotated decisively into distillate: the DOE on-highway diesel average rose **19.7 cents in a single week to \$5.454**, AAA diesel reached **\$5.4677**, within 35 cents of the all-time record, and US distillate stocks sit **12% below the five-year average, near 23-year lows**. Diesel is a freight and food-price input before it is a pump-price grievance. (iii) The downgrade needs **three consecutive closes at or below \$4.60 with no intervening print above \$4.70**. The series is **17 cents away, unchanged from the last edition**, and is sitting above the \$4.75 trigger that fired the channel. \$9.21 and \$9.30 stand vindicated: the named, testable condition has been measurable at 9, 16 and 17 cents across three editions and at no point invited a downgrade that would have been wrong within days.

2.2 · Stage-4 thresholds

Threshold	Test	State on the 18 August close
A · Failed auction	A Treasury auction clearing with a tail above its when-issued level. This is a failed-auction test, not a yield-level test (\$9.33).	DOES NOT ARM. No coupon auction settled between 17 and 18 August. The August refunding settled on 17 August. The 20-year auction falls on 19 August and the 30-year TIPS reopening on 20 August — both after this snapshot. Context, not test: the 30-year closed 9.00 bp above the 5.216% at which the 13 August auction cleared on Monday and 6.98 bp above on Tuesday, and 25.60 bp above the 13 May stop of 5.050%. Per \$9.29 the reference has moved — the US has term-funded at 5.216%, so 5.050% is a historical marker. A caution for the 19 August result: search engines return a 5.047% / \$16bn 20-year figure that is the 21 May 2025 auction, not this one. The comparable is the 22 July 2026 20-year , which cleared 5.163% and tailed 0.5 bp , graded weak, with indirects at 69.1%.
B · 30Y above 5.20% with 10Y above 4.65%	Both legs on a confirmed close.	ARMED, for a THIRD consecutive close. 14 Aug 5.2593 / 4.6922, 17 Aug 5.3060 / 4.7219 , 18 Aug 5.2858 / 4.7060. Monday's 30-year leg cleared by 10.60 bp — the widest 30-year clearance of the war — with the 10-year clearing by 7.19 bp, the second-widest binding leg after 31 July's 7.24. Tuesday's binding leg is 5.60 bp. This is still the FOURTH arming since 29 July, not a fifth — the 14 August arming has simply persisted — and it is the joint-longest armed run of the current regime, level with 10–12 August. \$9.19: count armings, not cycles. The change worth recording is not the state but the margin: every earlier state in this sequence was decided by under 6 bp on one leg, and Monday cleared by more than 7 on both.
C · MOVE above 130	Confirmed close.	NOT ARMED. 74.98, which is 55.02 points below. The war high is 115.02 on 26 March and the series low 65.39 on 18 June. The 14 August framing that MOVE sat below its pre-war anchor is withdrawn: it has closed above 73.38 on both sessions since, at 75.63 and 74.98. The structural observation survives in weakened form — rate volatility remains close to pre-war while the 30-year sits 67.7 bp above its own anchor at a fresh war high — but it is no longer true that the market has normalised its expectation of movement, only that it has not yet un-normalised it.

2.3 · The cross-asset picture

The US macro data across these two sessions was weak and the long end ignored it, which is now a pattern rather than an observation. Housing starts fell **12.4% m/m** to 1.239 mn against a 1.35 mn consensus, with single-family down 9.9%; permits rose 5.0%; industrial production rose 0.2% with capacity utilisation at 76.3%, **3.1 points below its 1972–2025 average**; pending home sales fell 2.3% against a +0.3% consensus; the NAHB builder index printed **35, a sixteenth consecutive month below 40**, with 35% of builders cutting prices. The Atlanta Fed cut its Q3 GDPNow to **4.03% from 4.31%**. Against that, Empire State manufacturing printed 20.6 against 11 expected. **On any conventional reading of that mix the long end rallies. It set a war high instead.** Follow the sequence from the previous edition and the point becomes structural: on 14 August the curve sold off into retail sales of –0.6% and Michigan sentiment of 51.0; on 17 August it sold off further into nothing but geopolitics. **The bond market has stopped trading US demand and started trading the supply of two things: duration, at a debt load near \$40tn, and oil, at 0.07 mb/d of effective spare capacity.** The dollar corroborates: DXY has moved two hundredths of a point across three sessions while the 30-year set a record. **A term-premium sell-off does not bid the dollar; a safe-haven one does.** The FOMC minutes of the 28–29 July meeting — a 9–3 hold with Hammack, Kashkari and Logan all dissenting for a **hike**, the first three-way dissent since 2016 — are released on 19 August after this snapshot, and the market prices roughly a **31% probability of a September hike** on the freshest sourceable CME reading, dated 14 August. **Nobody is pricing a cut.** **The reconciling fact remains the relay, and this week it grew a second leg.** Bloomberg reported LNG carriers conducting ship-to-ship transfers on 17 August, and Reuters reported Aramco resuming loadings at Ras Tanura and Juaymah after a three-week gap. Brent is \$90 rather than \$130 because a shadow logistics system is moving perhaps 9 mb/d — half of pre-war throughput — by transfer rather than by transit, through water in which a seafarer was killed on Monday and two ballistic missiles were fired at a Gulf state on Tuesday. **That relay is doing the work spare capacity would normally do, it has no redundancy, and the four-day rally in crude is the market beginning to price the possibility that it is not indefinitely sustainable. It is still not priced in the VIX at 15.84.**

3 · Shock score

Six channels, 0–5 each, summed 0–30. Bands: 0–7 watch · 8–14 stress · 15–21 systemic-risk watch · **22–30 crisis**. Market channels move only on confirmed closes; event channels move only on events, not announcements (\$9.11). Hysteresis is asymmetric by design: upgrades on a sustained break, downgrades only on a sustained reversal past a wider threshold.

Channel	Score	Basis for this edition	Move
1 · Maritime denial	5 / 5	Day 173. UKMTO Update 086 takes the cumulative count 89 to 91, and its annex records ZERO transits of any kind on both 15 and 16 August. UKMTO 115-26: a cargo ship struck in the engine room 0.5nm off Oman with one crew fatality . Hormuz SEVERE, all threat levels held. AIS-on vessels are being hailed and directed to the northern Iranian route. Kpler 5 then 0 across the weekend; TankerMap 7-day average 1.1 against ~21/day.	held (at max)
2 · Oil price shock	2 / 5	Brent closed \$89.45 on 18 Aug, the highest since 31 July and a fourth consecutive up-session; the active contract closed \$91.02. \$5.55 below the \$95 upgrade and \$16.97 above the \$72.48 downgrade; \$3.98 on the active contract. The upgrade gap narrowed \$2.88, the largest single-edition narrowing of the war, and has narrowed three editions running.	held — and closing
3 · US inflation impulse	5 / 5	A THIRD consecutive 5Y5Y close above 2.30%, at 2.3243%. BE10 closed 2.3077%, its highest since 15 June and 5.08 bp above its pre-war anchor, from 0.21 bp a fortnight ago. Import and export prices fell hard. The documented downgrade at the 2.142% anchor is 18.23 bp away, widened for a second edition.	held (at max)
4 · Treasury stress	5 / 5	The 30-year closed 5.3060% on 17 August — a NEW WAR HIGH and the first close above 5.30%. MOVE jumped 6.05 points to 75.63, ending the sub-75 run and returning above its pre-war anchor. The 30-year downgrade leg failed by 30.60 bp, the widest of the war. Both legs moved away at once — a first.	held (at max)
5 · Political stress	5 / 5	AUTMUSAG \$4.77 on 17 Aug , joint-highest since 10 June, above the \$4.75 trigger. The DOE weekly corroborated the reversal on 18 Aug at \$4.049, up 4.3 cents. The \$4.60 condition is 17 cents away, unchanged. AAA diesel \$5.4677, within 35 cents of its all-time record; the diesel crack set an all-time high of \$102.20 on 17 Aug.	held (at max)
6 · Escalation risk	5 / 5	The MoU lapsed on 17 August with no extension , confirmed by UKMTO 086 and by Bloomberg reporting Trump will not revive it. Iran declared a ‘fully offensive’ posture with a few-weeks ultimatum and threatened a strike to break the blockade (announcement, \$9.11). Iran fired two ballistic missiles at the UAE on 18 August — an EVENT. Trump threatened to bomb Oman. Blockade tally 62 to 64. Against it: a 21-day gap in CENTCOM combat releases.	held (at max)
TOTAL	27 / 30	CRISIS band. Ninth consecutive edition at 27. Five of six channels are pinned at the top of the scale and the sixth, oil, is three points below it. The composite therefore cannot register the most adverse two-session window since 30 July — a lapsed ceasefire framework, a declared offensive posture, a state-on-state ballistic launch, a seafarer killed and a threat to bomb the mediator. Read the composition, not the total (\$9.7, \$9.27).	27 → 27 → 27

4 · What has changed since the 17 August edition

1 · The MoU lapsed on 17 August with no extension and no successor process, and this is now confirmed by both parties and by a primary military source. The 17 June Islamabad-brokered memorandum carried a 60-day clock. Al Jazeera, CNN, CBS, CNBC and the NYT reported the expiry on the day; **Bloomberg reported on 18 August that Trump will not try to revive it; and UKMTO Update 086 independently records the lapse and links it to a rise in attack frequency.** The last edition flagged this as the most consequential undated item in the document and could not source it. **It is now resolved, and the circulating ‘12 August extension’ is formally retracted** — Tier 2, single-sourced to unnamed Pakistani officials, never corroborated, falsified by events.

2 · Iran stated a ‘fully offensive’ military posture, set a few-weeks ultimatum, and threatened a ‘timely and precise’ attack to break the naval blockade. Reuters, 17 August, from a senior Iranian official. Ghalibaf, as Speaker of the Majlis, said the strait stays shut until the blockade is lifted, assets unfrozen, sanctions eased and military operations halted on all fronts. **Per \$9.11 an announcement is not an event and the channel does not move on it** — but it is the first time in this war that Tehran has publicly attached a deadline to a threat against the blockade itself.

3 · Iran fired two ballistic missiles at the UAE on 18 August, the first such launch since May. Both fell in or near territorial waters, no casualties; UAE residents received a phone alert two hours before the statement; Iran denied it. Bloomberg, AP, Al Jazeera and Euronews all carried it. **This is a state-on-state event, not an announcement**, and it follows the UAE naming Iran and using the word ‘piracy’ on 14 August. **NOT FOUND, and it is the tell: any UAE or GCC sanction, designation or referral flowing from that language. The rhetoric has not become policy.**

4 · Washington threatened to bomb the mediator. Trump, Fox News, 17 August: ‘if Oman gets in the way, we’ll bomb the s--- out of them’. **The Washington Post reported the next day, citing US officials, that the reason is Oman’s bilateral Hormuz deal with Iran.** In the same interview he claimed a direct back-channel to the IRGC, which Baghaei called psychological warfare and the IRGC denied outright; on 18 August he said no talks are taking place or scheduled.

5 · The 17 August close was never published, and the snapshot understated Brent by \$2.60 — the largest upside crude reconciliation error the monitor has recorded. Brent closed \$89.03, not the \$86.43 carried; the close was **+\$2.46 on the day, not –\$0.14.**

The 30-year closed **5.3060%**, a new war high, against the 5.2593% published; 2s10s closed 54.248 bp, the steepest since 19 May, against 52.777; MOVE jumped 6.05 points. **This is the sixth occasion on which the monitor has had to withdraw a published reading because the snapshot missed the session (\$9.18, \$9.31).**

6 · \$9.25 is corrected, and the correction is applied to this edition's own data. The last edition observed the 30-year printing 5.2593% on both 14 and 17 August, identical to four decimal places, and reasoned that because every other field on the row had moved the print was genuine rather than a carry. **It was a carry, and the true close was a war high 4.67 bp higher.** The rule is restated: **an identical-to-four-decimals field is UNRESOLVED regardless of whether the row around it is live.** Accordingly the 5-year and 10-year, which print unchanged to four decimals on 18 and 19 August, are reported in this edition as unresolved and carry no d/d.

7 · The 30-year set a war high and the Treasury downgrade moved further away on BOTH legs at once. A first. MOVE went from 4.15 points below its pre-war anchor to 2.25 above it, while the 30-year leg went from failing by 25.93 bp to **failing by 30.60 bp, the widest gap of the war.** Threshold B has been armed on three consecutive closes and on Monday the 30-year leg cleared by **10.60 bp, the widest 30-year clearance of the war** — against a sequence in which every earlier state was decided by under 6 bp on one leg.

8 · Oil is the only channel with headroom and the gap has now narrowed in three consecutive editions. \$9.78, then \$8.43, now **\$5.55** on the scored series and **\$3.98** on the active contract. Brent has closed up three sessions running, and risen on a fourth intraday, on stalemate rather than on a supply loss — the reported catalysts were the weekend transit collapse, the strike off Oman, the indefinite-blockade report and a record diesel crack pulling crude from the product end.

9 · UKMTO 086 records two consecutive days of ZERO transits and a crew fatality 0.5nm off Oman. The cumulative count goes 89 to 91. **115-26** struck a cargo ship in the engine room, killing a crew member, with the Omani Coast Guard responding; **114-26 is a Somali-basin hijack and is not Iran-related.** A casualty conflict between UKMTO and a secondary outlet is recorded unreconciled. The blockade tally rose 62 to 64, a sharp deceleration consistent with an empty waterway, and a **91-vessel figure on CENTCOM's own media page is irreconcilable with it and is not used.**

10 · The diplomatic track has been made conditional on a document that does not exist. Qatar said on 18 August that mediators will return to push for US–Iran talks **after** the Iran–Oman Hormuz deal is announced. That deal is **single-sourced to Tehran**: Baghaei says the route map is agreed and a joint declaration is being prepared, then conceded on 18 August that it is delayed by 'destructive efforts'; **Muscat has never confirmed any of it**, and the terms — reportedly entry near the Iranian coast, exit along the Omani side, no tolls for a transitional two to four months — remain unpublished by either party.

11 · Oman's public silence is now total and load-bearing, and it is documented from the ministry's own indexes. Nothing on the two tankers struck in its territorial waters on 14 August; nothing on UKMTO 115-26, in which a seafarer died 0.5nm off its coast and its own Coast Guard rendered assistance; nothing in reply to being threatened with bombardment. The most recent Hormuz-relevant news item remains **8 August**, the most recent Hormuz statement **14 July**, the most recent Oman–Iran joint statement **23 June**. The one signal is **Sultan Haitham's 17 August visit to Abu Dhabi with his defence, interior and transport ministers**; the readout says only that regional security was discussed, and no inference is scored on it.

12 · The covert relay extended into LNG and Aramco resumed loading inside the strait. Bloomberg reported LNG carriers conducting ship-to-ship transfers on 17 August. Reuters reported Aramco resuming loadings at Ras Tanura and Juaymah after a three-week gap, three VLCCs lifting ~2 mn bbl each between 12 and 16 August. Windward assessed the **first breach of the blockade since 13 July** — the sanctioned LPG carrier AXON I under a false Angola flag. **Kharg's three terminals were empty on both 16 August passes with ~16.7 mn bbl sitting in floating storage.** Yanbu has been fully AIS-dark for six weeks.

13 · The DOE weekly corroborated the gasoline reversal, and the real move is diesel. \$4.049, up 4.3 cents, with the rise entirely interior and the East Coast and California both falling. **The DOE on-highway diesel average rose 19.7 cents in one week to \$5.454; AAA diesel reached \$5.4677, within 35 cents of its all-time record; and the US front-month diesel crack hit an all-time high of \$102.20/bbl on 17 August**, roughly five times normal, with European diesel near \$170/bbl. US distillate stocks are 12% below the five-year average.

14 · Corrections and re-verifications carried into this edition. (a) The 17 August edition's 30-year, 2s10s and Brent readings are withdrawn by name (items 5 and 6 above). (b) The claim that MOVE sat below its pre-war anchor is **withdrawn** — it has closed above 73.38 twice since. (c) The Brent–WTI active spread peaked at \$6.37 on 17 August, which is wide but **NOT a war record: \$6.82 on 5 May is**; the 'widest since 5 May' framing survives, the record framing would not have. (d) Threshold B has been armed on three consecutive closes but this is still the **fourth arming since 29 July, not a fifth** — count armings, not cycles. (e) A claim that the US struck Iran overnight on 18 August could not be sourced to any Tier 1 outlet and is contradicted by CENTCOM's own release index; **rejected.** (f) A 91-vessel redirected figure on CENTCOM's media page conflicts with its own 17 August statement of 64; **not used.** (g) The Houthis claim of an 18 August strike on Jazan is **Tier 3 and uncorroborated**, unlike the confirmed 9 and 13 August attacks; carried as a claim. (h) A 5.047% / \$16bn 20-year auction result circulating for 19 August 2026 is **the 21 May 2025 auction** and must not be used. (i) Ghalibaf is Speaker of the Majlis, not Iran's lead negotiator, as one outlet described him. (j) The NAHB figure of 35 is confirmed as the **August 2026** release, per \$9.13.

5 · Scenario map

Scenario	Prob.	Description	Shift from 17 Aug and why
Deal collapse on terms	42%	Modal for a sixth consecutive edition. The strait stays shut not because talks failed to start but because the terms are irreconcilable: Iran demands sanctions relief, released assets, an end to the blockade and a halt to operations on all fronts; the US demands restored free passage, no nuclear weapons and no proxy funding, and is running a blockade to compel it.	+4 (38 → 42), the largest single move on this map since 7 August. The MoU lapsed with no extension and no successor process , Trump has ruled out reviving it and says nothing is scheduled, and Iran has attached a few-weeks ultimatum to a threat against the blockade. The two condition sets do not intersect at any point , and both sides now argue the deadline never mattered — which is the argument you make when there is nothing to replace it with.
Return to full war	23%	Sustained US or Israeli strikes inside Iran resume, or Iran strikes US regional bases or Gulf states directly.	+2 (21 → 23). Iran fired two ballistic missiles at the UAE on 18 August, the first since May , and stated a 'fully offensive' posture with an explicit threat of a 'timely and precise' attack to break the blockade. Trump threatened to bomb Oman. Capped at +2 by the single strongest countervailing fact in the document: CENTCOM's public release index shows nothing on combat inside Iran since 29 July, a 21-day gap , verified directly this edition.
Contained but violent	21%	Attacks continue on shipping and on Gulf energy infrastructure; the blockade persists; neither side crosses into sustained state-on-state strikes.	−1 (22 → 21) . The category is under strain from both ends. It absorbed a crew fatality 0.5nm off Oman and a claimed third strike on Jazan — but a ballistic launch at a Gulf state is not 'contained but violent' , and probability moves out of this cell into full war rather than staying. The blockade tally decelerating to +2 in three days is not restraint; it is an empty waterway.
Regional relapse	10%	The conflict widens through the Red Sea, Lebanon, Iraq or the Saudi energy complex rather than through the strait itself.	−2 (12 → 10) . The quietest periphery in weeks and the fall is mechanical rather than benign. UKMTO 086 records no confirmed attacks in the southern Red Sea or Bab el-Mandeb in the period; no dated Israeli strike on Lebanon 17–19 August after the 15 August strikes that killed 11; nothing at all in Iraq . Al-Mokha remains closed and the Jazan claim is Tier 3 and uncorroborated. Probability has moved to the strait, not out of the war.
Mediated pause	4%	A negotiated de-escalation restores partial transit under a supervised regime.	−3 (7 → 4), the lowest this map has carried and a full reversal of last edition's rise . The two points added on 17 August for the Iran–Oman route map are withdrawn and one more with them. Qatar has made the un-issued joint declaration the gate on all mediation; Baghaei says it is delayed; Oman has never confirmed it; and the United States has threatened to bomb the co-signatory over it . Pakistan has been silent since 12 August and no talks are scheduled by either party's account.

Probabilities sum to 100. **The two paths in which the strait stays shut carry 65% between them, UP from 60% — reversing the first and only fall this map has recorded**, which came last edition on the strength of the Iran–Oman route map. That instrument has since failed to materialise, been made the precondition for all other mediation, and become the stated reason the US is threatening its co-signatory.

6 · Watchlist · next 24–72 hours

1 · The three US events that fall AFTER this snapshot, all on 19 August. The **20-year auction** is the first long-end supply since the 30-year cleared at 5.216% and comes with the 30-year at a fresh war high; per \$9.29 read the bid composition, not the tail, and note the 22 July 20-year **tailed 0.5 bp**. The **EIA weekly** carries the follow-up test named two editions ago: **do crude imports stay near 7.3 mb/d or revert to the 6.3 four-week average?** The API estimated a small crude draw and a **2.8 mn bbl distillate draw** for the week. And the **FOMC minutes** of the 9–3 July hold, with three dissents for a hike, are the first look inside a committee that has withdrawn forward guidance.

2 · The SPR fell below 300 mn bbl for a second week and the EIA print will confirm the level. DOE data cited on 18 August puts the reserve at **293.4 mn bbl for the week ending 14 August, down a further 5.3 mn** from 298.7 mn — which was itself the first reading below 300 mn since **January 1983**. Against ~415 mn pre-war and 714 mn of authorised capacity, the reserve is roughly 41% full. **This figure is DOE-sourced via a secondary outlet and is flagged as such until the EIA weekly confirms it.**

3 · Whether Brent takes out \$95, which is now the only live scoring question in the document. \$5.55 on the scored continuation, \$3.98 on the active contract, after three consecutive editions of narrowing and four consecutive up-closes. **The trigger requires SUSTAINED closes above \$95, not a touch**, so a single print through it changes nothing — but this is the first time in the war that the oil channel has been within one bad session of its upgrade on the contract the market actually trades.

4 · Whether Iran acts on the ‘few weeks’ ultimatum, and whether CENTCOM’s 21-day silence breaks. The single most load-bearing negative in this document is that CENTCOM has published nothing on combat inside Iran since 29 July. **Per \$9.23 that is an absence-of-evidence claim and it is re-verified against the primary index every edition it is repeated**, because it is falsified by any single release. It is the reason full war sits at 23% rather than higher.

5 · Whether the Iran–Oman joint declaration is ever issued, and whether Muscat confirms anything. Qatar has made it the gate on all mediation. It is single-sourced to Tehran, Baghaei says it is delayed by ‘destructive efforts’, no fee or security terms have been published by either party, and the US has threatened to bomb the co-signatory over it. **Watch fm.gov.om, not Iranian spokesmen** — and note that a joint declaration would be the first Oman–Iran joint statement since 23 June.

6 · Whether the UAE’s position hardens after being fired at. Naming Iran and saying ‘piracy’ on 14 August was a departure; two ballistic missiles on 18 August is a different order of provocation. **Nothing material has followed either — no sanction, no designation, no GCC emergency session, no UNSC referral.** The 19 August Rubio call with Sheikh Tahnoun, in which Rubio ‘underscored the importance of freedom of navigation’, is the only dated diplomatic response so far.

7 · UKMTO Update 087 and VRA Overview No.3, neither yet published, and whether zero-transit days become the run rate rather than the exception. Two consecutive nil days in the annex is a first. **Update 081 remains unretrievable for a fifth edition.**

8 · Whether the sub-75 MOVE regime is over. It closed 75.63 then 74.98 — the second is technically below the line by two hundredths, which under \$9.18 is a session and not a regime. **No MOVE print alone can move the Treasury channel while the 30-year leg is 28.58 bp away and set a war high on Monday**, so the question is diagnostic rather than scoring: can rate volatility stay near pre-war through a 20-year auction, a 30-year TIPS reopening and Jackson Hole?

9 · Jackson Hole, 27–29 August, topic ‘Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy’. Chair Warsh’s first symposium keynote as chair is expected Friday 28 August. **Because he has deliberately withdrawn written forward guidance, a set-piece speech carries unusual weight** — and it lands into a market pricing a September hike at roughly 31% and no cut at all. The agenda has not been published.

10 · Bessent’s promised sanctions, still not delivered. OFAC’s recent-actions page was read directly on 19 August: **no Iran action on 17, 18 or 19 August**, the only entry being an 18 August ICC and Venezuela package, and the last Iran designations dated 7 and 29 July. **Two Treasury releases with directly relevant titles could not be dated and are NOT attributed to this window.** Watch the page, not the rhetoric.

7 · Source log

Tier	Source	Used for
Tier 1 · market data	Bloomberg extract ‘US Iran BBG Data.xlsx’, refreshed 19 Aug 2026	All price, yield, volatility and gasoline series. 167 raw rows × 99 columns ; header row scanned rather than hardcoded. Front-month auto-detect resolved CO2/CL2; DXY resolved as ‘DXY Index’. The 27 Feb anchor was re-verified field by field and is unchanged. The \$9.8 row-level check clears and the corrected \$9.19 field-level check raises two flags (5Y and 10Y, identical to 4dp on 18 and 19 Aug), both reported as unresolved.
Tier 1 · official	UKMTO / JMIC; US CENTCOM; US Treasury; Federal Reserve G.17; Census Bureau; NAHB; BLS; EIA; DOE; OFAC; US State Department; Oman Ministry of Foreign Affairs	UKMTO JMIC Update 086 (to 18 Aug, ICOD 181500Z) read directly at ukmto.org — threat levels, incidents 114-26 and 115-26, the transit annex, the MoU-lapse assessment and the CENTCOM blockade tally. CENTCOM release index read directly on 19 Aug (most recent combat entry 29 July). CENTCOM’s own 17 Aug statement of 64/3/2. Census housing starts and permits, 18 Aug. Fed G.17 industrial production, 18 Aug. BLS import and export prices, 18 Aug. NAHB HMI, 17 Aug, confirmed as the August 2026 release. EIA weekly retail gasoline and diesel survey, released Tue 18 Aug. OFAC recent actions read 19 Aug — no Iran action in the window. fm.gov.om news and statements indexes read directly 19 Aug. State Department readout of the 19 Aug Rubio call.
Tier 1 · news	Reuters · Bloomberg · AP · Al Jazeera · CNN · CBS · CNBC · NYT · Washington Post · Fox News · Euronews · Lloyd’s List Intelligence	The MoU lapse (Al Jazeera, CNN, CBS, CNBC, NYT, 17 Aug; Bloomberg, 18 Aug, on Trump refusing to revive it). Reuters’ 17 Aug exclusive on the ‘fully offensive’ posture. The UAE ballistic-missile statement (Bloomberg, AP, Al Jazeera, Euronews, 18 Aug). Trump’s Oman threat (Fox News, 17 Aug; CNN, CBS, WaPo, Al Jazeera) and the WaPo report of its stated reason. Qatar gating mediation on the Hormuz deal (Al Jazeera, 18 Aug). Aramco resuming loadings (Reuters on Kpler and Vortexa, 18 Aug). LNG ship-to-ship transfers (Bloomberg, 17 Aug). Kpler transit counts via Reuters. The record diesel crack (Bloomberg, 18 Aug).
Tier 2 · commercial trackers	Kpler · Windward · Vortexa · TankerMap · IMF PortWatch · LSEG · UANI · TankerTrackers.com	Transit counts, dark-fleet and Kharg imagery, vessel positioning. Every count is reported with its own vessel universe and denominator and no average is taken (\$9.19, \$9.24) — UKMTO annex vs Kpler vs Windward vs TankerMap vs PortWatch, four baselines, four answers, all published. Windward’s own caveat that its series is sensitive to satellite collection effort is carried. UANI and TankerTrackers published nothing 17–19 Aug. UANI is an advocacy organisation and is used only for imagery-corroborated vessel counts.
Tier 3 · state media	IRNA · IRIB · Tasnim · SABA · Defa Press	Labelled and corroborated before use. The IRGC’s denial of the back-channel reaches this document through Tasnim and is used only because Al Jazeera relays it. The Houthi claim of an 18 Aug drone strike on Jazan originates with SABA, was corroborated by NO Tier 1 outlet, drew no Saudi or Aramco comment, and is carried as a CLAIM and used for nothing. The Hormuz ‘Smart Management Plan’ bill is sourced entirely to IRNA and Tier 2 aggregators — no Tier 1 outlet has covered it at any stage — and it remains in committee with no floor vote and no Guardian Council action.

Tier	Source	Used for
NOT FOUND — recorded, not filled	Explicit negatives	No transit count of any kind for 19 Aug from any provider. No EIA weekly, no 20-year auction result and no FOMC minutes at the time of this snapshot — all three fall on 19 Aug after the Singapore cut. No UKMTO Update 087 and no VRA Overview No.3. No UKMTO incident numbered 116-26 or higher. No Omani statement on the 14 Aug attacks in its own waters, on UKMTO 115-26, or on Trump's threat. No Omani confirmation of the route map and no published fee or security terms. No Iran–Oman joint declaration. No Hegseth or SecDef statement 17–19 Aug. No Gharibabadi or Rezaei statement 17–19 Aug. No UAE or GCC sanction, designation or referral. No Israeli strike on Lebanon dated 17–19 Aug and no Iraq spillover event. No Pakistani, Swiss, UN or IMO activity. No CME FedWatch reading datestamped 17 Aug or later. No Fed speaker 17–19 Aug. No Jackson Hole agenda. No Baltic week-34 VLCC, Suezmax or Aframax averages. No war-risk premium newer than Marsh's 7.5–10% of hull of 22 July. No new EIA, IEA, OPEC or OPEC+ release 17–19 Aug. No analyst price-forecast revision dated in the window. No revision to the 30 Aug Jizan restart. No OFAC Iran action.
Rejected as stale, mis-dated or unsourceable	Checked and discarded	The '12 August agreement to extend the MoU' — Tier 2, unnamed Pakistani sources, never corroborated and falsified by the 17 Aug lapse. Formally retracted. A 5.047% / \$16bn 20-year auction result circulating for 19 Aug 2026: it is the 21 May 2025 auction. A claim that the US struck Iran overnight around 18 Aug: no Tier 1 source, contradicted by CENTCOM's own release index. A 91-vessel redirected figure on CENTCOM's media page, irreconcilable with its own 17 Aug statement of 64. A '13 vessels against a ~140 baseline' UKMTO attribution that could not be verified against the primary annex and conflicts with Windward. Carried forward from previous editions: the 'two VLCCs, 4 mn bbl at Kharg' March-vintage post; Türkiye Today and Seoul Economic Daily on a Hormuz toll law (March); gCaptain's 'Hormuz Is Reopening' (16 Jun); Axios on a 'Hormuz Coalition' (16 Mar).

8 · On-demand update protocol

#	Step	Detail
1	Refresh and integrity-check the extract	Scan the header row rather than hardcoding columns; auto-detect the Brent and WTI front month. Run the row-level stale check (\$9.8) by diffing the prior row against the figures published for it, and the field-level check (\$9.19) for values identical to four decimals. This edition: the row check CLEARS decisively — every field of the 17 Aug row differs from the published snapshot — and two fields are flagged and reported as UNRESOLVED under the corrected rule.
2	Compute deltas and test every trigger explicitly	d/d against the last confirmed close, w/w against five sheet-rows back, and vs the 27 Feb anchor re-verified field by field. Test all four market channels and Stage-4 A, B and C on the confirmed close only, and record the distance in basis points or dollars so the direction of travel is visible edition to edition. Run min, max and last-prior-occurrence queries on the full series before writing any superlative (\$9.32) — three were checked and one corrected this edition.
3	Verify the news on both tracks and re-verify what was inherited	Military and diplomatic on one track, shipping, energy and macro on the other. Re-run negative claims every edition they are repeated (\$9.23) — absence-of-evidence decays faster than positive facts. State the exact query alongside the answer. Where several trackers disagree, publish every number with its denominator and take no average (\$9.24).
4	Reconcile the previous snapshot and withdraw conclusions by name	The Singapore-morning cut regularly misses the US session, in either direction and sometimes in both at once. It has now produced six occasions on which a published reading had to be withdrawn, most recently by \$2.60 on Brent. Report the gap on every asset, and where the previous edition built a narrative on the snapshot, withdraw the conclusion explicitly rather than quietly restating the number (\$9.20).
5	Score on confirmed closes, with hysteresis, and explain the composition	Never move a market channel on an intraday print; never whipsaw on a single session; never move a downgrade rule to match the level that fired the upgrade. When the scale is saturated, say so — the total registers neither deterioration nor improvement (\$9.7, \$9.27), so the analysis has to carry what the number cannot. This edition is the clearest case yet: the most adverse two-session window since 30 July, and a flat 27.

9 · Methodology

Data. All market series come from a single Bloomberg extract refreshed by the user each working day. The latest row is an intraday snapshot taken during the Singapore morning; the previous row is normally a confirmed close. The sheet's structure changes between uploads — tickers are relabelled, columns inserted, history restated — so the parser scans the header row on every run rather than addressing columns by index. **Restatements are normal and absolute levels are not strictly comparable with pre-restatement editions; directional analysis is continuous.** The front-month Brent and WTI continuations (CO2, CL2) are the scored series and print about \$1.57 below the active Brent contract and about \$0.90 below the active WTI contract (COA, CLA) that the press quotes. Both are published here. **There was no 18 August edition, so this document covers two sessions and publishes the 17 August close in full rather than as a d/d reference.**

Scoring. Six channels, each 0–5, summed to 0–30. Two event channels — maritime denial and escalation risk — and four market channels. **Market channels move only on confirmed closes, never on intraday prints. Hysteresis is asymmetric by design:** a channel is upgraded on a sustained break of its trigger and downgraded only on a sustained reversal past a wider threshold. The value of that asymmetry is unusually visible in this edition. On 13 August the 5Y5Y level whose sustained break fired the US-inflation channel to 5 was itself broken to the downside, and the channel did not move because the documented downgrade sat far lower. **Three closes later that break has been fully reversed and the gap to the downgrade has widened twice.** A symmetric trigger would have produced a downgrade on 13 August and an upgrade within a week. The same logic held the political channel through a six-session gasoline decline that then round-tripped in two backfilled sessions.

The saturated scale. Five of the six channels are at 5; only oil, at 2, is not — **three points below the cap, not one.** The composite therefore cannot register further deterioration in the strait, and, as the 14 August edition demonstrated, cannot register improvement in the financial complex either. **A flat 27 does not mean a stable situation; it means the instrument has run out of range in both directions.** This

edition is the starkest illustration the monitor has produced: a lapsed ceasefire framework, a declared offensive posture, a state-on-state ballistic launch at a Gulf partner, a seafarer killed in the strait, a threat to bomb the mediator, two days of zero transits and a new war high in the 30-year — **and the number did not move**. Readers should attend to the composition and to the distance-to-trigger figures, reported in basis points and dollars precisely so that movement inside a frozen total remains visible.

Sourcing. Every factual claim carries an attribution. Iranian, Houthi and other state media are labelled Tier 3 and are corroborated against Tier 1 before being used for anything that could move a score. **‘Not found’ is recorded as a finding rather than filled with an estimate**, and negative claims are re-verified against the primary source on every edition in which they are repeated — the 21-day gap in CENTCOM combat releases and Oman’s publication silence are both re-checked against their primary indexes each edition, because each would be falsified by a single release. Where independent trackers give different transit counts — as they routinely do, because they count different vessel universes — every figure is published with its own baseline named, and no average is taken.

Anchors and triggers in force. Pre-war reference is the 27 February 2026 close, re-verified field by field this edition and unchanged: Brent \$72.48 · WTI \$67.02 · 2Y 3.375% · 5Y 3.502% · 10Y 3.938% · 30Y 4.611% · 2s10s +55.64 bp · 5Y5Y 2.142% · 10Y breakeven 2.2569% · MOVE 73.38 · VIX 19.86 · DXY 97.608 · gasoline (AAA all-grades) \$3.52 · Henry Hub \$3.06 · TTF €31.23 · Asia LNG ¥1,669. Live triggers: oil to 3 on sustained closes above \$95 and to 1 on a mediated pause with a close at or below \$72.48; US inflation to 4 on sustained closes at or below 2.142%; Treasury to 4 on a 30-year close under 5.00% together with MOVE under 75, sustained; political stress to 4 on three consecutive AUTMUSAG closes at or below \$4.60 with no intervening print above \$4.70. **The dual gasoline series are not re-based:** AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades, daily) is the scored reference and USRFRUSA (DOE regular-grade, weekly) is corroboration only.

A note on the § references. Numbered references of the form §9.n throughout this document point to the monitor’s internal operating instructions and pitfalls register, which records every failure mode the process has hit since June and the rule adopted in response. They are not sections of this document. **§9.25 is amended by this edition**, having been applied incorrectly in the last one: an identical-to-four-decimals field is now treated as UNRESOLVED whether or not the row around it is live.

Known limitations. The Singapore-morning cut misses part or all of the US session; the reconciliation gap is regime-dependent and has ranged from 13 cents to \$3.99 on Brent within a fortnight, and this edition’s was **+\$2.60, the largest upside crude error recorded**, with the 30-year 4.67 bp adrift and carrying a war high the snapshot did not see. Series go dark for multiple sessions and backfill later, sometimes against the prevailing trend rather than with it. A row can fail to refresh entirely, and an individual field can carry forward inside an otherwise live row — which is precisely what happened to the 30-year on 17 August. Every one of these failure modes has occurred since 29 July, each is tested for explicitly on every run, and the results of those tests are published in this document rather than assumed.